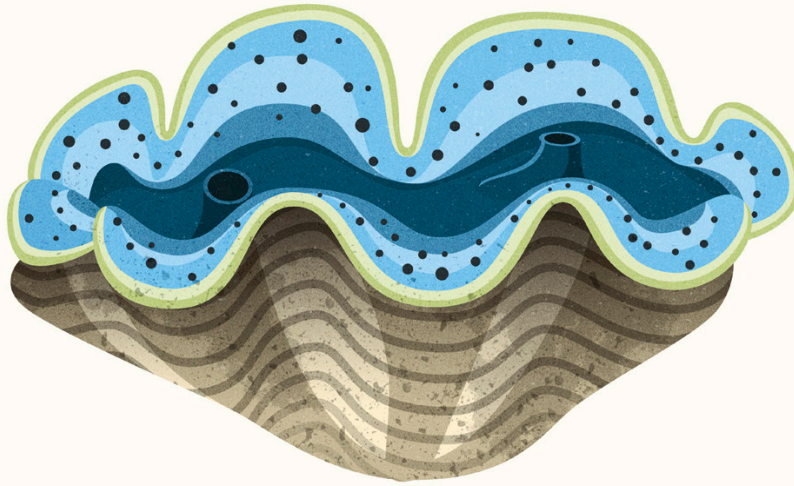


# Giant clam



**A**mong the rocky cracks and caves of a coral reef, you might spot a giant blue mouth. It belongs to the small giant clam. This monster mollusc is up to 40 cm (16 in) long, but it is small in comparison to the giant clam, which is the biggest shelled mollusc in the world. Giant clams can grow to 10,000 times heavier than garden snails, which are also members of the mollusc group!

Giant clams are related to mussels, scallops, and oysters, and like them they have a hard shell made of two hinged parts. The frilly lips yawn open during the day, allowing the sun to reach the algae living inside. The algae use the sunlight to make food, which the clam eats.

*Each giant clam has several hundred  
eyes on its wavy lips.*